justification, and more justice—accept Tibet's case [over China's], which is also in our national interest? What native impotence makes him willing to strike but afraid to wound? What confuses him into subverting all three aims of his Northern policy by his single misunderstanding of the position of Tibet? Is it plain ignorance? Is it simple cowardice? Or is it a simple national policy induced by military weakness, ideological ambiguities and weakening of nationalism?'

Upadhyaya accused Nehru of showing little serious intent in acting upon border transgressions by the Chinese. 'While on the one hand, he [Nehru] had been declaring that India was firm in her stand, on the other he counselled forbearance in the Lok Sabha, saying that there were limits to firmness also. Of course there are limits to everything, but unfortunately the Prime Minister's limits are set to startling points.'

The prime minister's attitude to China, concluded Upadhyaya, was 'characteristic of his weak and timid nature'.

The argument that India's first prime minister was pusillanimous with regard to China was also articulated by that obsessive critic of all that Nehru stood for, the brilliant socialist thinker Ram Manohar Lohia. In a speech in Hyderabad in October 1959, Lohia asked Nehru and his government 'to take back the territory the Chinese have captured by whatever means it thinks fit … Increase the country's strength and might,' he thundered; 'then alone China's challenge can be met.' Then, when Zhou Enlai visited Delhi in April 1960 and was met with a hostile demonstration organized by the Jana Sangh, Lohia said that 'if any one deserves a black flag demonstration, it is no one else but Mr. Nehru for extending an invitation to an outright aggressor'.

The third view of Nehru's attitude to Chinese claims was perhaps the most interesting. Exuding pity rather than contempt, this held Nehru to be a naïve man misled by malign advisers and by his own idealism. Responding to the border clashes in the second half of 1959, C. Rajagopalachari wrote several essays urging Nehru to abandon his long held and deeply cherished